MY ENGLISH TOOLKIT

The Choice Meter

Modals: How much choice do you have?

YOU CHOOSE
can · may · don't have to

GOOD IDEA?
should · shouldn't

NO CHOICE
have to · must · must not · can't

Modal + V1

No **to**. No **-s**.
She **can** drive.
~~She can to drive.~~ ~~She cans drive.~~
Only have to changes:
I **have to** · she **has to**

Questions: the modal goes first

(have to uses **do**)
Can I park here?
May I come in?
Should I call back?
Do I **have to** pay now?
~~Do you can help me?~~

Name:

_____

Make it:

1. Fold on every dashed line: in, out, in.
2. Stand it up. Green side to you, red side to your partner.
3. Sort the cards! Then turn it around.

fold

YOU CHOOSE ●○○

can

It's possible. It's OK. I am able.

- I **can** speak Spanish.
- You **can** park here after 6.

? Can I sit here?

Build an example

WHO?
I · My son · We

MODAL
can

DO WHAT? (V1)
speak 2 languages · drive · cook rice · fix a phone

WHERE? WHEN?
at work · on the weekend · very well

Pick one from each row. Change words to make it true for you.

My sentences:

_____

_____

_____

Ask a partner: Can you ___?

My partner said:

_____

▼ cards here ▼

fold

YOU CHOOSE ●○○

may

Polite: Is it OK? Use it with a teacher, a boss, or a doctor.

- **May** I leave early today?
- Yes, you **may**.

may is more polite than **can**.

Build an example

WHO?
I · we · my son

MODAL
may

DO WHAT? (V1)
leave early · ask a question · come in · use your pen

WHERE? WHEN?
today · now · please

Pick one from each row. Change words to make it true for you.

My sentences:

_____

_____

_____

Ask a partner: May I ___?

My partner said:

_____

▼ cards here ▼

fold

turn over for more →

YOU CHOOSE ●○○

don't have to

Not needed. You choose. It's OK to do it, and OK not to do it.

- I **don't have to** work on Sunday.
- She **doesn't have to** pay for the bus.

he / she / it: **doesn't have to**

Build an example

WHO?
I · My wife (doesn't) · We

MODAL
don't have to

DO WHAT? (V1)
work · cook · pay · wake up early

WHERE? WHEN?
on Sunday · today · for the bus

Pick one from each row. Change words to make it true for you.

My sentences:

_____

_____

_____

Ask a partner: Do you have to ___?

My partner said:

_____

▼ cards here ▼

← the back of “don’t have to”

GOOD IDEA? ●●○

should shouldn't

Advice. **should** = a good idea. **shouldn't** = a bad idea.

- You **should** see a doctor.
- You **shouldn't** click strange links.

? Should I call back?

Build an example

WHO?
You · My friend · Kids

MODAL
should / shouldn't

DO WHAT? (V1)
drink water · sleep 8 hours · click strange links · call the doctor

WHERE? WHEN?
every day · at night · if you feel sick

Pick one from each row. Change words to make it true for you.

My sentences:

Ask a partner: What should I do if ___?

My partner said:

▼ cards here ▼

fold

NO CHOICE ●●●

have to has to

Required. Your job, your school, or your landlord says so.

- I **have to** wear a uniform.
- He **has to** pay rent on the 1st.

? Do I **have to** sign here?

Build an example

WHO?
I · My husband (has to) · We

MODAL
have to / has to

DO WHAT? (V1)
wear a uniform · pay rent · take medicine · clock in

WHERE? WHEN?
every day · on the 1st · at 8:00

Pick one from each row. Change words to make it true for you.

My sentences:

Ask a partner: Do you have to ___ at work?

My partner said:

▼ cards here ▼

fold

NO CHOICE ●●●

must

A strong rule. Often the law or a safety rule.

- You **must** wear a seatbelt.
- Workers **must** wash their hands.

Signs and forms use **must**.

Build an example

WHO?
You · Drivers · Workers · Tenants

MODAL
must

DO WHAT? (V1)
wear a seatbelt · wash your hands · stop at a red light · show your ID

WHERE? WHEN?
in the car · at work · at the bank

Pick one from each row. Change words to make it true for you.

My sentences:

Ask a partner: What must you do at work?

My partner said:

▼ cards here ▼

fold

NO CHOICE ●●●

must not can't

Never do it. It's not allowed.

- You **must not** smoke here.
- You **can't** park here.

must not ≠ don't have to
must not = NO! · don't have to = you choose

Build an example

WHO?
You · Kids · Tenants

MODAL
must not / can't

DO WHAT? (V1)
smoke · park · text and drive · have a pet

WHERE? WHEN?
here · in the hospital · in the building

Pick one from each row. Change words to make it true for you.

My sentences:

Ask a partner: What can't you do at work?

My partner said:

▼ cards here ▼

1

wear a seatbelt in the car

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

2

smoke in the hospital

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

3

pay rent on the 1st of the month

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

4

see a doctor if your cough doesn't stop

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

5

eat a lot of sugar

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

6

work on Sunday

(Your job is Monday–Friday.)

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

7

bring lunch

(Lunch is free at work today.)

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

8

ask the teacher: leave class early

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

9

speak two languages

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

10

wear a uniform at work

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

11

have a dog

(The lease says: No pets.)

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

12

show your ID at the bank

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

13

drink more water

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

14

share your PIN with a stranger

Who? I · you · he · she · we · they

15

Your own:

_____

_____

16

Your own:

_____

_____